elections. Their goal in these elections, they claimed, was to create a political bloc in the parliament that would have the power to block initiatives of the soon-to-be-formed government—in other words, to be a force of balance. If they succeeded in realizing this goal, it would serve as a basis and a springboard for the realization of additional goals in the future, whose ultimate goal would be to take control of the state and impose sharia.

In fact, the Muslim Brotherhood did put forward a candidate of their own—Mohamed Morsi—for the presidential elections, and won; for the first time in its history, Egypt had a president who was also a leader of the Muslim Brotherhood. Morsi removed incumbent defense minister Tantawi and appointed General Abdel Fattah el-Sisi in his stead. Before long, el-Sisi initiated a "quiet revolution" in which President Morsi (who was tried on various charges, convicted, and sentenced to death, though the sentence was not carried out and it is doubtful that it ever will be) was deposed. El-Sisi took power and was elected president in the general elections, and the rest is history.

Tunisia and Egypt are cases in which the phenomenon of social networks succeeded in generating revolutions that have still not reached their conclusions, which are difficult to predict. There is no guarantee that a democratic regime awaits these countries at the end of the road.

The other Arab states in North Africa (Libya, Algeria, Sudan, and Morocco) and the Middle East (Syria, Saudi Arabia, the Gulf States, Jordan, Yemen, and Lebanon) are at different points in the revolutionary process. It is still too early to point to any successes of the social networks in these cases. Therefore, Tunisia and Egypt should be seen as the exception rather than the rule.

To paraphrase Thomas Friedman in his *New York Times* column: the revolution was inevitable, but the revolutionaries may not succeed in rising to democracy, only to the height of the minaret of the mosque!